

The Cop and the Anthem

O. Henry · 1904

First published: New York Sunday World, Dec 1904

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Four_Million/The_Cop_and_the_Anthem (revision 14232999), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Cop and the Anthem suggest about homelessness and society?
- What does The Cop and the Anthem suggest about fate and irony?
- What does The Cop and the Anthem suggest about redemption?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Cop and the Anthem	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*homelessness and society* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Cop and the Anthem

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about O. Henry's life or times connects to homelessness and society in “The Cop and the Anthem”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (homelessness and society, fate and irony, redemption).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter, born on 11 September 1862 in Greensboro, North Carolina. He trained as a pharmacist, moved to Texas, and worked as a draftsman, bank teller and humorous journalist. Convicted of embezzling from the Austin bank where he had worked (he maintained his innocence), he served about three years in the Ohio Penitentiary (1898–1901), where he began publishing stories as O. Henry. In New York he wrote a story a week for the New York World and produced hundreds of tales of ordinary city people, famous for their warmth, wordplay and twist endings. He died in New York on 5 June 1910.

Historical and cultural context

Around 1900 the homeless men of New York's parks faced brutal winters. "The Island" was Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) in the East River, site of a workhouse and prison where petty offenders served short terms; for some, a winter there meant food and shelter.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in the New York World in December 1904; collected in The Four Million (1906).

Then: Popular with O. Henry's large newspaper audience.

Now: Taught for its situational irony and its satire of a society in which jail is the only shelter for the poor.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Soapy, a homeless man, decides to get himself arrested so he can spend the winter on the Island. He tries crime after crime.

Main themes

- irony of fate.
- poverty and society.
- redemption.

Why it matters

The story satirizes how society treats the poor and asks whether people get the chance to change.

Spoilers · teacher only

Every attempt fails. Moved by an organ anthem outside a church, he resolves to reform and find work, and at that moment a policeman arrests him for loitering; he gets three months on the Island.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Cop and the Anthem: Have you ever gotten exactly what you wanted at exactly the wrong moment?
Prompt: Before we open The Cop and the Anthem: Have you ever gotten exactly what you wanted at exactly the wrong moment?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
situational irony; satire; diction; Blackwell's Island.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter, born on 11 September 1862 in Greensboro, North Carolina. He trained as a pharmacist, moved to Texas, and worked as a draftsman, bank teller and humorous journalist. Convicted of embezzling from the Austin bank where he had worked (he maintained his innocence), he served about three years in the Ohio Penitentiary (1898–1901), where he began publishing stories as O. Henry. In New York he wrote a story a week for the New York World and produced hundreds of tales of ordinary city people, famous for their warmth, wordplay and twist endings. He died in New York on 5 June 1910. The world of the book. Around 1900 the homeless men of New York's parks faced brutal winters. "The Island" was Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) in the East River, site of a workhouse and prison where petty offenders served short terms; for some, a winter there meant food and shelter. Publication and reception. First published in the New York World in December 1904; collected in The Four Million (1906). Then: Popular with O. Henry's large newspaper audience. Now: Taught for its situational irony and its satire of a society in which jail is the only shelter for the poor.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "ON his bench in Madison Square Soapy moved uneasily." slowly and put it in my own words: On his bench in Madison Square, Soapy moves uneasily. Next, craft. I notice the setting is a public park bench, which tells us he has no home. The strongest word is "uneasily": it shows his discomfort and the coming cold. Then, effect. What does this first sentence suggest about Soapy? My answer: Soapy is homeless and restless; the story will follow his attempts to get to jail.

> *ON his bench in Madison Square Soapy moved uneasily. (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "ON his bench in Madison Square Soapy moved uneasily." slowly and put it in my own words: On his bench in Madison Square, Soapy moves uneasily. Next, craft. I notice the setting is a public park bench, which tells us he has no home. The strongest word is "uneasily": it shows his discomfort and the coming cold. Then, effect. What does this first sentence suggest about Soapy? My answer: Soapy is homeless and restless; the story will follow his attempts to get to jail.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Soapy, a homeless man, decides to get himself arrested so he can spend the winter on the Island. He tries crime after crime. Themes to track: irony of fate.: poverty and society.: redemption.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: fate and irony. Prediction: Soapy, homeless on his bench in Madison Square, will try to get arrested so he can spend the winter in jail. Question: why does the world keep refusing to give him what he wants?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Cop and the Anthem: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: fate and irony. Prediction: Soapy, homeless on his bench in Madison Square, will try to get arrested so he can spend the winter in jail. Question: why does the world keep refusing to give him what he wants?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Cop and the Anthem still matter? The story satirizes how society treats the poor and asks whether people get the chance to change.
Anchor question: Why might The Cop and the Anthem still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story satirizes how society treats the poor and asks whether people get the chance to change.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
O. Henry lived in New York and wrote a weekly story for the New York World. How might writing weekly about city life shape his stories? Answer: Accept answers such as: he wrote about ordinary New Yorkers; quick plots with twist endings; humor and sympathy for the poor.
Exit ticket: O. Henry lived in New York and wrote a weekly story for the New York World. How might writing weekly about city life shape his stories?
Answer: Accept answers such as: he wrote about ordinary New Yorkers; quick plots with twist endings; humor and sympathy for the poor.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Cop and the Anthem.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "O. Henry" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/O-Henry); NCpedia, "Porter, William Sydney (O. Henry)" (https://www.ncpedia.org/biography/porter-william-sydney); O. Henry Museum (Austin) (https://www.austintexas.gov/department/o-henry-museum); NYC Parks, Roosevelt Island history (https://www.nycgovparks.org/)

Lesson 2: The Cop and the Anthem

Focus: a reversal that punishes a change of heart

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "The Cop and the Anthem" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (homelessness, petty crime, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Homelessness; petty crime. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…r cakes and an eye like the cherry in a Manhattan cocktail. "Hey, Con!" Neatly upon his left ear o…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes homelessness; petty crime.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Soapy, a homeless man in Madison Square, wants three warm months in jail on Blackwell's Island for the winter. He tries to get arrested: skipping a restaurant bill, breaking a window, harassing a woman, disturbing the peace, stealing an umbrella. Every attempt fails. Moved by church music, he resolves to reform and find work, and at that moment a policeman arrests him for loitering; he gets three months.

Background: Published in 1904. Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) held New York's workhouse and jail.

Significance: A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to redemption because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes homelessness; petty crime.
Prompt: Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to redemption because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the anthem awakens his conscience.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: loitered — lingered; hung about; congenial — pleasant and well suited; scorned — look down on with disdain; impudent — marked by casual disrespect; motives — reasons for doing something. "impudent": Origin: Latin impudēns ("shameless").
Words: loitered: lingered; hung about · congenial: pleasant and well suited · scorned: look down on with disdain · impudent: marked by casual disrespect · motives: reasons for doing something

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1904. Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) held New York's workhouse and jail. A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing. Irony: Every crime fails; innocence is punished. Diction / vocabulary: Ornate vocabulary ("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans. Structure: A series of attempts, each foiled, builds to the reversal. Watch for the anthem: memory of his better past and a call to change.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" slowly and put it in my own words: Soapy wants three months in the jail on the Island to escape winter. Next, craft. I notice that "craved" usually goes with food or comfort, not jail. The strongest word is "craved": it shows how desperate he is that prison seems like comfort. Then, effect. Why does Soapy want to go to jail? My answer: Soapy wants to go to jail because winter is coming and he is homeless, so a warm cell with food seems a relief; O. Henry uses this irony to show how harsh poverty is.

> *Three months on the Island was what his soul craved (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" slowly and put it in my own words: Soapy wants three months in the jail on the Island to escape winter. Next, craft. I notice that "craved" usually goes with food or comfort, not jail. The strongest word is "craved": it shows how desperate he is that prison seems like comfort. Then, effect. Why does Soapy want to go to jail? My answer: Soapy wants to go to jail because winter is coming and he is homeless, so a warm cell with food seems a relief; O. Henry uses this irony to show how harsh poverty is.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Arcadia is an ideal paradise; calling a prison that shows how desperate Soapy is. Ask: How does this line connect to redemption? Expected: The anthem awakens his conscience. (Ironic grandeur.)

> *In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia* (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Arcadia is an ideal paradise; calling a prison that shows how desperate Soapy is.
Ask: How does this line connect to redemption?
Expected answer: The anthem awakens his conscience. (Ironic grandeur.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Cop and the Anthem develops the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. When the text says "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.
Task: Annotate the story for irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Cop and the Anthem develops the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. When the text says "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society? Ask: is the ending funny or tragic?
Anchor question: Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?
Facilitation: Ask: is the ending funny or tragic?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. ("Three months on the Island was what his soul craved", The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. ("Three months on the Island was what his soul craved", The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Key takeaway: the anthem awakens his conscience.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Every crime fails; innocence is punished.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Ornate vocabulary ("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans.
- **Structure:** A series of attempts, each foiled, builds to the reversal.

Themes and how they develop

- **redemption:** the anthem awakens his conscience.

Symbols and motifs

- **the anthem:** memory of his better past and a call to change.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) His goal.
- "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) Ironic grandeur.
- "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48) The ending.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose.
Evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4)
Reasoning: Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
loitered (verb)	lingered; hung about	*Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem.*	
congenial (adjective)	pleasant and well suited	*Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable.*	
scorned (verb)	look down on with disdain	*He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city's dependents.*	
impudent (adjective)	marked by casual disrespect	*He made eyes at her, was taken with sudden coughs and "hems," smiled, smirked and went brazenly through the impudent and contemptible litany of the "masher."*	"impudent": Origin: Latin impudēns ("shameless"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/impudent#Etymology)
motives (noun)	reasons for doing something	*He viewed with swift horror the pit into which he had tumbled, the degraded days, unworthy desires, dead hopes, wrecked faculties and base motives that made up his existence.*	
magistrate (noun)	a local official who judges minor cases	*An accommodating magistrate would do the rest.*	"magistrate": Origin: Latin magistrātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/magistrate#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with homelessness and society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16,

17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Soapy want for the winter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three months in jail on the Island
2. What happens when Soapy breaks a store window? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The policeman chases another man
3. What makes Soapy decide to change his life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Church organ music, an anthem
4. What does Soapy resolve to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Find work and reform
5. What finally happens? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He is arrested and sentenced to three months
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Cop and the Anthem" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Soapy, a homeless man in Madison Square, wants three warm months in jail on Blackwell's Island for the winter. He tries to get arrested: skipping a restaurant bill, breaking a window, harassing a woman, disturbing the peace, stealing an umbrella. Every attempt fails. Moved by church music, he resolves to reform and find work, and at that moment a policeman arrests him for loitering; he gets three…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Cop and the Anthem"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Cop and the Anthem" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem." What does "loitered" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: loitered: lingered; hung about.
10. Reread: "Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable." What does "congenial" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: congenial: pleasant and well suited.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Cop and the Anthem" suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing.
2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

3. How does the setting in this story shape what we understand about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “The hibernatorial ambitions of Soapy were not of the highest.”, why might Henry have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Cop and the Anthem”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Soapy, a homeless man in Madison Square, wants three warm months in jail on Blackwell's Island for the winter. He tries to get arrested: skipping a restaurant bill, breaking a window, harassing a woman, disturbing the peace, stealing an umbrella. Every attempt fails. Moved by church music, he…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Cop and the Anthem” set up that the rest of The Cop and the Anthem will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. On structure: A series of attempts, each foiled, builds to the reversal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island,” said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with homelessness and society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. On diction / vocabulary: Ornate vocabulary

("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Published in 1904. Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) held New York's workhouse and jail. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island,” said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Cop and the Anthem” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Cop and the Anthem”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island,” said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to fate and irony: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Henry need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. On irony: Every crime fails; innocence is punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how "The Cop and the Anthem" treats a reversal that punishes a change of heart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Cop and the Anthem see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve homelessness and society? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask O. Henry about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 29: ""'Tis one of them Yale lads _____' the goose egg they give to the Hartford College." Word bank: celebratin, imagined, joyfully, enchantment
   Key: celebratin
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 11: "Soapy stood still, with his hands in his _____, and smiled at the sight of brass buttons." Word bank: Manhattan, restaurant, clutches, pockets
   Key: pockets
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 14? "Men who smash _____ do not remain to parley with the law's minions."
   A. windows
   B. strolled
   C. inhabitants
   D. carpenter
   Key: A (windows)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 17: ""No cop for youse," said the waiter, with a voice like butter cakes and an eye like the cherry in a _____ cocktail." Word bank: joyfully, gibberish, Manhattan, pretensions
   Key: Manhattan
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He viewed with swift horror the pit into which he had tumbled, the degraded days, unworthy desires, dead hopes, wrecked faculties and base _____ that made up his existence." Word bank: scorned, motives, congenial, loitered
   Key: motives
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 7: "Soapy left his bench and _____ out of the square and across the level sea of asphalt, where Broadway and Fifth Avenue flow together." Word bank: restaurant, clutches, strolled, pockets
   Key: strolled

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 31? “Soapy stepped inside, secured the umbrella and _____ off with it slowly.”

   A. inhabitants

   B. sauntered

   C. epicurean

   D. pretensions

   Key: B (sauntered)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 15: “On the opposite side of the street was a restaurant of no great _____.” Word bank: sauntered, restaurant, pretensions, carpenter

   Key: pretensions

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 19: “Five blocks Soapy _____ before his courage permitted him to woo capture again.” Word bank: joyfully, Manhattan, travelled, pretensions

   Key: travelled

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “At the corners of four streets he hands his pasteboard to the North Wind, footman of the mansion of All Outdoors, so that the inhabitants thereof may make ready.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 2), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “At the corners of four streets he hands his pasteboard to the North Wind, footman of the mansion of All Outdoors, so that the inhabitants…”

    B. “When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without sealskin coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on…”

    C. “Soapy had confidence in himself from the lowest button of his vest upward.”

    D. “Soapy left his bench and strolled out of the square and across the level sea of asphalt, where Broadway and Fifth Avenue flow together.”

    Key: B (“When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without sealskin coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on…”)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 27 reveal about the character or situation? “On the sidewalk Soapy began to yell drunken gibberish at the top of his harsh voice.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 27), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 35 shapes its tone: ““Of course,” said the umbrella man—that is—well, you know how these mistakes occur—I—if it’s your umbrella I hope you’ll excuse me—I picked it up this morning in a restaurant—If you recognise it as yours, why—I hope you’ll————”” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 35), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 18 shapes its tone: “He arose, joint by joint, as a carpenter’s rule opens, and beat the dust from his clothes.” Pick two words and

explain their effect.

Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 18), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 10 to the story's treatment of redemption: "It seemed that his route to the coveted island was not to be an epicurean one." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 10), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance for redemption.

16. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 1: "When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without _____ coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on his bench in the park, you may know that winter is near at hand." Word bank: sealskin, pretensions, restaurant, Manhattan

    Key: sealskin

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 26? "He halted in the district where by night are found the lightest streets, hearts, vows and _____."

    A. librettos
    B. imagined
    C. epicurean
    D. inhabitants

    Key: A (librettos)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 15? "At a table he sat and consumed _____, flapjacks, doughnuts and pie."

    A. beefsteak
    B. enchantment
    C. unsuspected
    D. carpenter

    Key: A (beefsteak)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 26: "A sudden fear seized Soapy that some dreadful _____ had rendered him immune to arrest." Word bank: restaurant, joyfully, enchantment, sauntered

    Key: enchantment

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 38? "Because he wanted to fall into their _____, they seemed to regard him as a king who could do no wrong."

    A. epicurean
    B. Camembert
    C. clutches
    D. sauntered

    Key: C (clutches)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "An accommodating _____ would do the rest." Word bank: scorned, magistrate, loitered, congenial

    Key: magistrate

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 24 to the story's treatment of redemption: ““Sure, Mike,” she said joyfully, “if you'll blow me to a pail of suds.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 24), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance for redemption.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Soapy want for the winter?

    A. A room at a hotel

    B. A train ticket south

    C. A job

    D. Three months in jail on the Island

    Key: D (Three months in jail on the Island)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 35: ““Of course,” said the umbrella man—that is—well, you know how these mistakes occur—I—if it's your umbrella I hope you'll excuse me—I picked it up this morning in a _____—If you recognise it as yours, why—I hope you'll———”” Word bank: imagined, Manhattan, restaurant, unsuspected

    Key: restaurant

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 8? “A roasted mallard duck, thought Soapy, would be about the thing—with a bottle of Chablis, and then _____, a demi-tasse and a cigar.”

    A. inhabitants

    B. Camembert

    C. restaurant

    D. strolled

    Key: B (Camembert)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 8: “If he could reach a table in the restaurant _____ success would be his.” Word bank: restaurant, librettos, inhabitants, unsuspected

    Key: unsuspected

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4: “Three _____ on the Island was what his soul craved”

    Key: months

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4).

    Sample answer: Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how redemption develops from an earlier story to "The Cop and the Anthem". Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the anthem awakens his conscience.
31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What makes Soapy decide to change his life?
    A. A friend's advice
    B. A letter
    C. Church organ music, an anthem
    D. A sermon

    Key: C (Church organ music, an anthem)
32. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 23? "Already he _____ he could feel the cozy warmth of the station-house."
    A. windows
    B. gibberish
    C. sauntered
    D. imagined

    Key: D (imagined)
33. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: His goal.
34. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Ironic grandeur.
35. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What finally happens?
    A. He gets a job
    B. He is given a coat
    C. He is arrested and sentenced to three months
    D. He goes south

    Key: C (He is arrested and sentenced to three months)
36. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when Soapy breaks a store window?
    A. The policeman chases another man
    B. He is arrested
    C. He runs away
    D. The owner thanks him

    Key: A (The policeman chases another man)
37. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 8 shapes its tone: "If he could reach a table in the restaurant unsuspected success would be his." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 8), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

38. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Cop and the Anthem”? Ornate vocabulary ("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans.

    A. Allusion

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Setting

    D. Structure

    Key: B (Diction / vocabulary)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His goal.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Ironic grandeur.

41. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city’s dependents.”, what does “scorned” most nearly mean?

    A. marked by casual disrespect

    B. pleasant and well suited

    C. look down on with disdain

    D. lingered; hung about

    Key: C (look down on with disdain)

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Three months on the Island,” said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The ending.

43. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 15 reveal about the character or situation? “On the opposite side of the street was a restaurant of no great pretensions.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 15), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Cop and the Anthem”? Every crime fails; innocence is punished.

    A. Irony

    B. Plot

    C. Symbolism

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Irony)

45. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He made eyes at her, was taken with sudden coughs and “hems,” smiled, smirked and went brazenly through the impudent and contemptible litany of the “masher.””, what does “impudent” most nearly mean?

    A. lingered; hung about

B. marked by casual disrespect

C. look down on with disdain

D. pleasant and well suited

Key: B (marked by casual disrespect)

46. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem.”, what does “loitered” most nearly mean?

A. look down on with disdain

B. pleasant and well suited

C. marked by casual disrespect

D. lingered; hung about

Key: D (lingered; hung about)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	16, 17, 18, 19, 7, 1, 9, 20, 21, 11, 11, 10, 12, 14, 13, 22	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	23, 24, 19, 21, 25, 26, 27, 11, 11, 10, 12, 14, 13, 28, 29, 30	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 6, 23, 31, 25, 26, 32, 12, 11, 33, 34, 11, 13, 14, 29, 22	recall 7, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	23, 21, 35, 16, 8, 36, 12, 10, 34, 11, 33, 13, 14, 22, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	5, 20, 18, 21, 10, 11, 12, 37, 14, 13, 38, 15, 39, 40, 22, 29	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	21, 7, 41, 5, 11, 12, 11, 37, 13, 14, 42, 30, 15, 29, 40, 22	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	27, 9, 7, 12, 10, 43, 11, 11, 14, 38, 28, 13, 22, 29, 15, 40	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	4, 41, 5, 11, 10, 12, 11, 44, 42, 37, 13, 14, 40, 22, 29, 15	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	5, 21, 32, 10, 11, 11, 43, 12, 34, 42, 13, 38, 14, 15, 29, 22	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
Graduate / PhD	4, 45, 1, 46, 12, 11, 43, 11, 10, 14, 38, 13, 37, 29, 22, 15	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Cop and the Anthem,” how does Henry show a reversal that punishes a

change of heart? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In The Cop and the Anthem, how does Henry develop the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Cop and the Anthem develops the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Cop and the Anthem suggests about a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how O. Henry uses irony in The Cop and the Anthem to complicate the reader's understanding of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Cop and the Anthem within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a reversal that punishes a change of heart responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Cop and the Anthem alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a reversal that punishes a change of heart follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Cop and the Anthem and its treatment of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Cop and the Anthem as evidence for a larger claim about a reversal that punishes a change of heart in The Cop

and the Anthem. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Cop and the Anthem as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Cop and the Anthem.

SAT-style questions

1. *He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city's dependents.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "scorned" most nearly mean?

   A. marked by casual disrespect

   B. look down on with disdain

   C. reasons for doing something

   D. a local official who judges minor cases

2. *The hibernatorial ambitions of Soapy were not of the highest. In them there were no considerations of Mediterranean cruises, of soporific Southern skies or drifting in the Vesuvian Bay. Three months on the Island was what his soul craved. Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Cop and the Anthem"?

   A. A story so convincing it becomes real

   B. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong

   C. A reversal that punishes a change of heart

   D. Love and rivalry destroyed by racial violence

SAT key: 1. B (look down on with disdain); 2. C (A reversal that punishes a change of heart)

Unit test

The Cop and the Anthem: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 8? “A roasted mallard duck, thought Soapy, would be about the thing—with a bottle of Chablis, and then _____, a demi-tasse and a cigar.”

   A. inhabitants

   B. Camembert

   C. restaurant

   D. strolled

   Key: B (Camembert)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30: “In his fancy the Island seemed an _____ Arcadia”

   Key: unattainable

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 2? “At the corners of four streets he hands his pasteboard to the North Wind, footman of the mansion of All Outdoors, so that the _____ thereof may make ready.”

   A. inhabitants

   B. sauntered

   C. sealskin

   D. clutches

   Key: A (inhabitants)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 15? “At a table he sat and consumed _____, flapjacks, doughnuts and pie.”

   A. beefsteak

   B. enchantment

   C. unsuspected

   D. carpenter

   Key: A (beefsteak)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 8: “If he could reach a table in the restaurant _____ success would be his.” Word bank: restaurant, librettos, inhabitants, unsuspected

   Key: unsuspected

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 26: “A sudden fear seized Soapy that some dreadful _____ had rendered him immune to arrest.” Word bank: restaurant, joyfully, enchantment, sauntered

   Key: enchantment

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What makes Soapy decide to change his life?

   A. A friend's advice

   B. A letter

   C. Church organ music, an anthem

   D. A sermon

   Key: C (Church organ music, an anthem)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 27? “On the sidewalk Soapy began to yell drunken _____ at the top of his harsh voice.”

   A. sauntered

   B. clutches

   C. sealskin

   D. gibberish

   Key: D (gibberish)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 1: “When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without _____ coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on his bench in the park, you may know that winter is near at hand.” Word bank: sealskin, pretensions, restaurant, Manhattan

   Key: sealskin

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 38? “Because he wanted to fall into their _____, they seemed to regard him as a king who could do no wrong.”

    A. epicurean

    B. Camembert

    C. clutches

    D. sauntered

    Key: C (clutches)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 9: “But as Soapy set foot inside the _____ door the head waiter’s eye fell upon his frayed trousers and decadent shoes.” Word bank: unsuspected, epicurean, restaurant, librettos

    Key: restaurant

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Soapy want for the winter?

    A. A room at a hotel

    B. A train ticket south

    C. A job

    D. Three months in jail on the Island

Key: D (Three months in jail on the Island)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 26? “He halted in the district where by night are found the lightest streets, hearts, vows and _____.”

    A. librettos

    B. imagined

    C. epicurean

    D. inhabitants

    Key: A (librettos)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What finally happens?

    A. He gets a job

    B. He is given a coat

    C. He is arrested and sentenced to three months

    D. He goes south

    Key: C (He is arrested and sentenced to three months)

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 10? “It seemed that his route to the coveted island was not to be an _____ one.”

    A. epicurean

    B. enchantment

    C. celebratin

    D. librettos

    Key: A (epicurean)

16. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 15 reveal about the character or situation? “On the opposite side of the street was a restaurant of no great pretensions.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 15), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

17. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His goal.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how redemption develops from an earlier story to “The Cop and the Anthem”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the anthem awakens his conscience.

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Soapy resolve to do?

    A. Leave New York

    B. Steal a coat

    C. Find work and reform

    D. Return home

    Key: C (Find work and reform)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 18? “He arose, joint by joint, as a _____’s rule opens, and beat the dust from his clothes.”

    A. clutches

    B. carpenter

    C. imagined

    D. Camembert

    Key: B (carpenter)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when Soapy breaks a store window?

    A. The policeman chases another man

    B. He is arrested

    C. He runs away

    D. The owner thanks him

    Key: A (The policeman chases another man)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 24: ““Sure, Mike,” she said _____, “if you’ll blow me to a pail of suds.” Word bank: restaurant, strolled, joyfully, clutches

    Key: joyfully

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He viewed with swift horror the pit into which he had tumbled, the degraded days, unworthy desires, dead hopes, wrecked faculties and base _____ that made up his existence.” Word bank: scorned, motives, congenial, loitered

    Key: motives

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 8? “Soapy had _____ in himself from the lowest button of his vest upward.”

    A. clutches

    B. confidence

    C. restaurant

    D. Manhattan

    Key: B (confidence)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4: “Three _____ on the Island was what his soul craved”

    Key: months

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 23? “Already he _____ he could feel the cozy warmth of the station-house.”

    A. windows

    B. gibberish

    C. sauntered

    D. imagined

    Key: D (imagined)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 17: ““No cop for youse,” said the waiter, with a voice like butter cakes and an eye like the cherry in a _____ cocktail.” Word bank: joyfully, gibberish, Manhattan,

pretensions

Key: Manhattan

28. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Ironic grandeur.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “If he could reach a table in the restaurant unsuspected success would be his.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 8), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His goal.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 15: “On the opposite side of the street was a restaurant of no great _____.” Word bank: sauntered, restaurant, pretensions, carpenter

    Key: pretensions

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 11: “Soapy stood still, with his hands in his _____, and smiled at the sight of brass buttons.” Word bank: Manhattan, restaurant, clutches, pockets

    Key: pockets

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 14? “Men who smash _____ do not remain to parley with the law’s minions.”

    A. windows
    B. strolled
    C. inhabitants
    D. carpenter

    Key: A (windows)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Cop and the Anthem”?

    A. A reversal that punishes a change of heart
    B. Wishes that defy fate
    C. The hunter becoming the hunted
    D. Guilt that the mind cannot hide

    Key: A (A reversal that punishes a change of heart)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 10 to the story's treatment of redemption: “It seemed that his route to the coveted island was not to be an epicurean one.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 10), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance for redemption.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Ironic grandeur.

37. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "An accommodating _____ would do the rest." Word bank: scorned, magistrate, loitered, congenial

    Key: magistrate

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 31? "Soapy stepped inside, secured the umbrella and _____ off with it slowly."

    A. inhabitants

    B. sauntered

    C. epicurean

    D. pretensions

    Key: B (sauntered)

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48: "Three months on the Island," said the _____"

    Key: Magistrate

40. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 29: ""'Tis one of them Yale lads _____' the goose egg they give to the Hartford College." Word bank: celebratin, imagined, joyfully, enchantment

    Key: celebratin

41. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? "At the corners of four streets he hands his pasteboard to the North Wind, footman of the mansion of All Outdoors, so that the inhabitants thereof may make ready." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A response that accurately paraphrases the passage (paragraph 2), cites a specific word or detail from it, and explains its significance.

42. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 19: "Five blocks Soapy _____ before his courage permitted him to woo capture again." Word bank: joyfully, Manhattan, travelled, pretensions

    Key: travelled

43. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 35: ""Of course," said the umbrella man—that is—well, you know how these mistakes occur—I—if it's your umbrella I hope you'll excuse me—I picked it up this morning in a _____—If you recognise it as yours, why—I hope you'll————"" Word bank: imagined, Manhattan, restaurant, unsuspected

    Key: restaurant

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "The Cop and the Anthem"? Every crime fails; innocence is punished.

    A. Point of view

    B. Characterization

    C. Irony

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: C (Irony)

45. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "He made eyes at her, was taken with sudden coughs and "hems," smiled, smirked and went brazenly through the impudent and contemptible litany of the "masher."", what does "impudent" most nearly mean?

    A. lingered; hung about

B. marked by casual disrespect

C. look down on with disdain

D. pleasant and well suited

Key: B (marked by casual disrespect)

46. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem.”, what does “loitered” most nearly mean?

A. look down on with disdain

B. pleasant and well suited

C. marked by casual disrespect

D. lingered; hung about

Key: D (lingered; hung about)

47. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city’s dependents.”, what does “scorned” most nearly mean?

A. marked by casual disrespect

B. pleasant and well suited

C. look down on with disdain

D. lingered; hung about

Key: C (look down on with disdain)

48. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4).

Sample answer: Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

49. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 7: “Soapy left his bench and _____ out of the square and across the level sea of asphalt, where Broadway and Fifth Avenue flow together.” Word bank: restaurant, clutches, strolled, pockets

Key: strolled

50. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable.”, what does “congenial” most nearly mean?

A. look down on with disdain

B. pleasant and well suited

C. lingered; hung about

D. marked by casual disrespect

Key: B (pleasant and well suited)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 15, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 1
HS Freshman		

	11, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 8, 7, 26, 12, 14, 27, 1, 28, 29, 30	recall 15, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	31, 9, 26, 23, 3, 13, 10, 4, 19, 22, 21, 8, 32, 33, 34, 29, 35, 36	recall 14, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 2
HS Junior	37, 20, 32, 11, 38, 4, 39, 24, 40, 21, 31, 6, 27, 8, 41, 29, 35, 18	recall 14, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 26, 7, 1, 2, 42, 27, 38, 32, 39, 43, 20, 8, 23, 16, 44, 29, 35	recall 14, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 1
AP	45, 32, 33, 40, 46, 15, 12, 47, 42, 24, 14, 25, 1, 7, 28, 16, 48, 18	recall 14, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 1
College Freshman	22, 24, 46, 21, 6, 13, 20, 26, 9, 19, 43, 12, 42, 31, 34, 28, 41, 48	recall 14, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 0
College Sophomore	31, 37, 3, 11, 43, 19, 7, 47, 49, 50, 26, 10, 40, 13, 4, 29, 30, 18	recall 15, inference 0, analysis 1, synthesis 2
College Junior	38, 13, 33, 43, 4, 31, 9, 15, 49, 50, 11, 46, 26, 22, 12, 28, 48, 18	recall 15, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 1
College Senior	45, 4, 13, 32, 42, 8, 27, 40, 20, 19, 25, 9, 3, 10, 29, 36, 18, 30	recall 14, inference 0, analysis 1, synthesis 3
Graduate / PhD	38, 14, 6, 9, 19, 1, 12, 42, 50, 24, 47, 37, 22, 20, 21, 28, 18, 30	recall 15, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 2

Final paper

The Cop and the Anthem: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how O. Henry develops homelessness and society across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Cop and the Anthem and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to fate and irony.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Cop and the Anthem. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Cop and the Anthem finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of redemption. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Homelessness and society

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Cop and the Anthem teaches about homelessness and society. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how O. Henry develops homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how O. Henry develops homelessness and society across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of homelessness and society. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how O. Henry's choices in The Cop and the Anthem (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of homelessness and society, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Cop and the Anthem's treatment of homelessness and society in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and irony

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Cop and the Anthem teaches about fate and irony. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how O. Henry develops fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how O. Henry develops fate and irony across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and irony. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how O. Henry's choices in The Cop and the Anthem (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and irony, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Cop and the Anthem's treatment of fate and irony in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Redemption

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Cop and the Anthem teaches about redemption. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how O. Henry develops redemption in The Cop and the Anthem. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how O. Henry develops redemption across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of redemption. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of redemption in The Cop and the Anthem. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how O. Henry's choices in The Cop and the Anthem (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of redemption, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Cop and the Anthem's treatment of redemption in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on redemption in The Cop and the Anthem that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on redemption in The Cop and the Anthem. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about redemption in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on redemption in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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